

HOW TO PROVE IT.

A platform does not declare itself safe for children. It produces evidence. This guide sets out, control by control, the evidence a digital service generates to demonstrate conformity with the Custorian standard — 139 auditable controls across six domains.

FORENINGEN CUSTORIAN CVR 46399455 COMPANION TO THE CUSTORIAN STANDARD,
DRAFT EN V0.2

HOW CONFORMITY WORKS

Custorian is a conformity standard, not a self-assessment badge. Conformity is determined against documented, measurable controls and evidenced by artefacts an independent assessor can inspect, test, and reproduce.

- **139 controls, six domains.** Each control is a single auditable requirement. **130 are required** for conformity; **9 are addressable** — applicable where relevant, with a documented justification if not implemented.
- **SHALL vs SHOULD.** A **SHALL** control is mandatory. A **SHOULD** control is recommended; non-implementation must be justified and recorded.
- **Certified by independent bodies.** The foreningen owns the scheme and licenses the “Custorian Certified” mark; certification itself is issued by independent accredited Certification Bodies under EC 765/2008. The foreningen does not certify platforms directly, and no vendor is privileged.
- **Evidence travels.** Most artefacts below already exist for platforms meeting DSA, GDPR, the UK AADC, the Online Safety Act or COPPA. Custorian maps them to one coherent child-safety frame, so you produce them once.

What an assessor expects. For every applicable control: a named owner, a current artefact (dated, version-controlled), and — where the control is testable — a reproducible result. “We do this” is not evidence. “Here is the configuration, the test, the log, and who signed it off” is.

SIX KINDS OF EVIDENCE

Every control is satisfied by one or more of these artefact types. The tables that follow tag each control with the primary type(s) expected.

- P

Policy / procedure — a documented, dated, owned written control.
- T

Test / metrics report — a reproducible measurement, ideally independently produced.
- A

Attestation / contract — a third-party assurance, DPA, or signed clause.
- C

Configuration / system export — the actual settings, schema, or architecture in effect.
- L

Logs / records — operational evidence the control runs in production.
- D

Demonstration — a screenshot, recorded walkthrough, or published page (URL).

Rows shaded grey are **addressable** controls (SHOULD): produce the evidence if applicable, or a recorded justification for non-applicability.

CS-AC · Age Controls

24 controls — age verification, age estimation, age-appropriate defaults, accuracy thresholds.

CONTROL	REQUIREMENT	EVIDENCE TO PRODUCE
CS-AC.1.1	SHALL implement age verification for all users.	C D Age-assurance system configuration + recorded verification walkthrough.
CS-AC.1.2	SHALL use at least two independent signals.	C Documented signal sources + assurance architecture diagram.
CS-AC.1.3	Self-declared age SHALL NOT be the sole method.	C T Config showing self-declaration cannot stand alone + negative test.
CS-AC.1.4	SHOULD support eIDAS digital age credentials when available.	C eIDAS integration config, or documented roadmap/justification.
CS-AC.1.5	SHALL NOT collect more data than necessary for verification.	P C Data-minimisation note + field-level data map for AV.
CS-AC.1.6	SHALL meet minimum accuracy thresholds (FAR $\leq$ 0.1%; facial MAE $\leq$ 2.0 yr; 13/18 boundary error $\leq$ 5%).	T Independent accuracy test report against the stated thresholds.
CS-AC.2.1	When age cannot be verified, SHALL default to the 13–15 bracket.	C T Fallback config + test of the unverifiable case.
CS-AC.2.2	If primary verification fails, SHALL fall back to secondary signals.	C T Fallback logic doc + primary-failure test.
CS-AC.2.3	All age verification events SHALL be logged for audit.	L Sample age-verification audit log (redacted).
CS-AC.3.1	Settings SHALL be maximally restrictive by default for child accounts.	C Default-settings export for a child account.
CS-AC.3.2	Defaults SHALL differ by age bracket (8–10, 11–12, 13–15, 16–17).	C Settings matrix per age band.
CS-AC.3.3	Location sharing SHALL be off by default for all minors.	C D Default config + minor-account screenshot.
CS-AC.4.1	Age-restricted features SHALL be actually gated, not just labelled.	T Gating test results demonstrating enforcement.
CS-AC.4.2	DMs from strangers SHALL be disabled by default for under-16.	C D Default messaging config + walkthrough.
CS-AC.4.3	Public profile visibility SHALL be off by default for under-16.	C D Default visibility config + screenshot.

CONTROL	REQUIREMENT	EVIDENCE TO PRODUCE
CS-AC.4.4	In-app purchases SHALL require parental approval for under-16.	C D Purchase-flow config + approval walkthrough.
CS-AC.4.5	Live streaming SHALL be disabled by default for under-16.	C Streaming gate configuration.
CS-AC.5.1	SHOULD periodically re-verify age near thresholds.	P L Re-verification policy + sample re-verify events.
CS-AC.5.2	Users SHALL NOT change age without re-verification.	C T Config + attempt-to-change test.
CS-AC.6.1	AV methods SHALL be documented and publicly available.	D Public-facing age-assurance methods page (URL).
CS-AC.6.2	SHOULD publish accuracy rates of age verification.	D Published accuracy figures.
CS-AC.6.3	AV SHALL NOT discriminate by disability, ethnicity, or socioeconomic status.	T Bias/fairness test across demographic groups.
CS-AC.7.1	Verifiable parental consent SHALL be obtained below consent age.	C D VPC mechanism config + consent walkthrough.
CS-AC.7.2	Consent mechanism SHALL be robust against child impersonation.	T Anti-impersonation test results.

CS-CD · Content & Design Safety

32 controls — detection, dark patterns, recommender systems, moderation, advertising.

CONTROL	REQUIREMENT	EVIDENCE TO PRODUCE
CS-CD.1.1	SHALL detect and action CSAM via hash-matching.	A C Hash-matching provider contract (e.g. PhotoDNA/NCMEC) + config.
CS-CD.1.2	SHALL detect grooming patterns in communications.	T Grooming-detection model card + accuracy metrics.
CS-CD.1.3	SHALL detect bullying and harassment.	T Detection model card + metrics.
CS-CD.1.4	SHALL detect self-harm and suicidal content.	T C Detection model card + crisis-routing config.
CS-CD.1.5	SHALL detect violent threat content.	T Detection coverage + metrics.
CS-CD.1.6	SHALL detect financial sextortion patterns.	T Sextortion-pattern detection report.
CS-CD.1.7	SHOULD detect AI-generated CSAM.	T AI-CSAM detection capability note.
CS-CD.1.8	Detection SHALL be effective across all supported languages.	T Per-language accuracy table.
CS-CD.2.1	SHALL NOT use infinite scroll for child accounts.	C D Config + child-account screenshot.
CS-CD.2.2	SHALL NOT use notification pressure (FOMO, streaks, urgency).	C D Notification config + design review.
CS-CD.2.3	Loot boxes / randomised rewards SHALL show odds.	D Odds-disclosure screenshot.
CS-CD.2.4	SHALL NOT use deceptive design to extract data.	D Dark-pattern design review report.
CS-CD.2.5	Disabling safety features SHALL require more effort than enabling.	D UX walkthrough showing friction asymmetry.
CS-CD.2.6	Autoplay SHALL be off by default for child accounts.	C Default configuration.
CS-CD.3.1	AI may classify but SHALL NOT generate child-facing intervention text.	P C Architecture statement + config proving no generative child-facing text.
CS-CD.3.2	Intervention language SHALL be age-appropriate.	D Intervention copy library per age bracket.
CS-CD.3.3	Interventions SHALL be culturally reviewed per language/region.	P Localisation / cultural review records.
CS-CD.3.4	No dialogue loop — SHALL NOT sustain conversation with children.	P T Design statement + no-sustained-conversation test.

CONTROL	REQUIREMENT	EVIDENCE TO PRODUCE
CS-CD.3.5	Intervention content SHALL be version-controlled and publicly auditable.	D Public version-controlled repository / changelog.
CS-CD.4.1	Child-facing interventions SHALL be screen-reader compatible.	T Screen-reader accessibility test.
CS-CD.4.2	Intervention text SHALL meet WCAG 2.1 AA.	T WCAG 2.1 AA audit report.
CS-CD.4.3	Crisis helpline actions SHALL be accessible via assistive input.	T Assistive-input accessibility test.
CS-CD.5.1	User reports SHALL be acknowledged within 24h.	L Acknowledgement-time logs / SLA report.
CS-CD.5.2	Illegal content SHALL be actioned within 24h.	L Action-time logs / transparency metric.
CS-CD.5.3	Moderation policy SHALL be published and child-comprehensible.	D Published policy (URL) + readability check.
CS-CD.5.4	Appeals process SHALL be accessible to children.	D Appeals flow walkthrough.
CS-CD.5.5	Age classification appeal SHALL be available.	D Appeal mechanism walkthrough.
CS-CD.6.1	Recommender SHALL NOT amplify harmful content to children.	T Recommender risk assessment + amplification test.
CS-CD.6.2	Children SHALL be able to opt out of personalised recommendations.	C D Config + opt-out screenshot.
CS-CD.6.3	SHOULD offer a non-personalised feed as default.	C Feed configuration.
CS-CD.7.1	Targeted advertising SHALL NOT be served to under-18s.	C Ad-targeting config proving exclusion of minors.
CS-CD.7.2	Ads to children SHALL be clearly labelled.	D Ad-label screenshot.

CS-DM · Data & Privacy for Minors

18 controls — data minimisation, SDKs, consent, DPIA/CRIA, retention, encryption.

CONTROL	REQUIREMENT	EVIDENCE TO PRODUCE
CS-DM.1.1	Threat detection SHALL process on-device by default.	P C Architecture doc + config showing on-device processing.
CS-DM.1.2	SHALL collect only data necessary for core functionality.	P C Data-minimisation policy + data inventory.
CS-DM.1.3	Data collection scope SHALL be documented and transparent.	D Published data-collection notice.
CS-DM.2.1	All embedded SDKs SHALL be documented with data practices.	D SDK inventory + data-practice table.
CS-DM.2.2	Analytics/tracking SDKs SHALL NOT profile children.	C A SDK config + DPA clauses.
CS-DM.2.3	Third-party DPAs SHALL cover children's data.	A Signed DPAs referencing children's data.
CS-DM.3.1	Consent SHALL be informed, granular, age-appropriate.	D Consent flow screenshots.
CS-DM.3.2	Withdrawal SHALL be as easy as giving consent.	D Withdrawal flow walkthrough.
CS-DM.3.3	Pre-ticked consent boxes SHALL NOT be used.	D Consent UI screenshot.
CS-DM.4.1	DPIA SHALL be completed for child data processing.	D Completed DPIA document.
CS-DM.4.1a	CRIA SHALL be conducted for services likely accessed by children.	D Completed Child Rights Impact Assessment.
CS-DM.4.2	Children's data SHALL have retention periods + automatic deletion.	P L Retention schedule + deletion-job logs.
CS-DM.4.3	Children/parents SHALL be able to export their data.	D Export feature walkthrough.
CS-DM.4.4	Children/parents SHALL be able to delete data and account.	D L Deletion flow walkthrough + confirmation log.
CS-DM.5.1	Data SHALL meet data-residency requirements.	C Hosting/region config + data-flow map.
CS-DM.5.2	Data SHALL be encrypted in transit and at rest.	A C Encryption attestation (TLS config, KMS/key management).
CS-DM.6.1	Automated profiling SHALL NOT exceed core safety.	P C Profiling policy + config.

CONTROL	REQUIREMENT	EVIDENCE TO PRODUCE	
CS-DM.6.2	Precise geolocation SHALL NOT be collected unless essential and consented.	C P	Geolocation config + justification.

CS-PR · Parental Rights & Controls

18 controls — dashboards, monitoring boundaries, age-graduated autonomy, age-out.

CONTROL	REQUIREMENT	EVIDENCE TO PRODUCE	
CS-PR.1.1	SHALL provide a parental control dashboard.	D	Dashboard walkthrough.
CS-PR.1.2	Dashboard SHALL show safety alerts, not message content.	D	Dashboard screenshot proving no message content.
CS-PR.1.3	Dashboard SHALL be accessible on the parent's device.	D	Cross-device walkthrough.
CS-PR.1.4	SHALL support multiple guardians (up to four; mutual-consent changes; non-digital channel).	C P	Config + multi-guardian procedure.
CS-PR.2.1	Parents SHALL NEVER see content — category, severity, timestamp only.	C	Alert data schema.
CS-PR.2.2	Parents SHALL NOT be able to enable keylogging.	P C	Statement + config proving no keylogging capability.
CS-PR.2.3	Alert metadata SHALL NOT allow content reconstruction.	C	Alert schema + privacy review.
CS-PR.3.1	13+ SHALL be notified monitoring is active (non-configurable).	D	Monitoring-notification screenshot.
CS-PR.3.2	Notification SHALL explain what/why in age-appropriate language.	D	Notification copy.
CS-PR.4.1	Sensitivity SHALL decrease and agency increase with age.	C	Age-graduation config matrix.
CS-PR.4.2	16+ SHALL be able to modify their own privacy settings.	C D	Config + walkthrough.
CS-PR.4.3	Parental override SHALL decrease with the child's age.	C	Override matrix by age.
CS-PR.5.1	Child self-reporting SHALL route to counsellor/helpline, bypassing parent.	D	Self-report flow walkthrough.
CS-PR.5.2	Crisis helpline SHALL be one tap from any safety alert.	D	Helpline-access screenshot.
CS-PR.6.1	Monitoring SHALL cease automatically at 18.	C L	Config + age-out event log.
CS-PR.6.2	Parent access SHALL be revoked at 18 (not parent-initiated).	L	Revocation log.

CONTROL	REQUIREMENT	EVIDENCE TO PRODUCE
CS-PR.6.3	On-device data SHALL be deleted within 24h of age-out.	L Deletion log.
CS-PR.6.4	Young adult SHALL have data access rights before erasure.	D Pre-erasure export walkthrough.

CS-MR · Monitoring, Detection & Response

30 controls — real-time detection, CSAM reporting, incident response, transparency.

CONTROL	REQUIREMENT	EVIDENCE TO PRODUCE	
CS-MR.1.1	SHALL implement real-time detection across 7 categories.	T	Detection coverage matrix.
CS-MR.1.2	Detection SHALL cover grooming, bullying, self-harm, violence, content wellness, sextortion, dangerous purchases.	T	Per-category capability evidence.
CS-MR.1.3	Accuracy metrics SHALL be published per language, quarterly.	T	Quarterly per-language accuracy report.
CS-MR.1.4	Detection SHALL NOT degrade performance > 10%.	T	Performance benchmark.
CS-MR.2.1	CSAM SHALL be reported to the designated authority within 1h of confirmed detection.	P L	Reporting SLA + report-time records.
CS-MR.2.2	CSAM evidence SHALL be preserved per legal requirements.	P	Evidence-preservation procedure.
CS-MR.2.3	NCMEC/national reporting channel SHALL be configured and tested.	A T	Channel registration + test record.
CS-MR.2.4	SHALL preserve metadata for CSAM/illegal content involving children.	P L	Procedure + sample.
CS-MR.2.5	SHALL apply cryptographic integrity to preserved evidence.	C	Hashing/integrity configuration.
CS-MR.3.1	Detection SHALL be consistent across devices.	T	Cross-device consistency test.
CS-MR.3.2	Institutional consent SHALL apply per child, not per device.	C	Consent-model config.
CS-MR.3.3	Detection history SHALL sync via encrypted on-device sync.	C	Sync architecture doc.
CS-MR.4.1	SHALL have an incident response plan for child safety events.	D	IR plan document.
CS-MR.4.2	Critical incidents SHALL be triaged within 1h.	P L	Triage SLA + sample.
CS-MR.4.3	IR SHALL notify affected child and parent (except where it compromises LE).	P	Notification procedure.
CS-MR.5.1	Incident evidence SHALL be preserved per applicable law.	P	Preservation policy.

CONTROL	REQUIREMENT	EVIDENCE TO PRODUCE	
CS-MR.5.2	Chain of custody SHALL be documented.	D	Chain-of-custody template + sample.
CS-MR.6.1	SHOULD participate in industry threat-intelligence sharing.	A	Membership / participation evidence.
CS-MR.6.2	Detection patterns SHALL be updated at least monthly.	L	Update changelog.
CS-MR.7.1	SHALL publish child-safety transparency reports at least annually.	D	Published transparency report.
CS-MR.7.2	Reports SHALL include volumes, categories, response times, appeals, removals.	D	Report contents check.
CS-MR.8.1	SHALL conduct a systemic risk assessment for minors annually.	D	Risk assessment document.
CS-MR.8.2	Risk assessment SHALL cover algorithmic amplification.	D	RA section on amplification.
CS-MR.8.3	Mitigations SHALL be documented and reviewed annually.	D	Mitigation register.
CS-MR.9.1	SHALL have a responsible disclosure policy for child-safety vulnerabilities.	D	Published vulnerability-disclosure policy.
CS-MR.9.2	Disclosed vulnerabilities SHALL be triaged within 48h.	L	Triage timestamps.
CS-MR.10.1	Pattern updates SHALL be reviewed before deployment.	P L	Change-review procedure + approvals.
CS-MR.10.2	Updates SHALL NOT introduce bias or suppress legitimate expression.	T	Bias test on pattern updates.
CS-MR.10.3	Rollback capability SHALL exist for false-positive spikes.	C T	Rollback mechanism doc + test.
CS-MR.11.1	SHOULD account for atypical communication patterns.	P	Note on neurodiverse / atypical-communication handling.

CS-GO · Governance & Policy

17 controls — Child Safety Officer, training, vendors, regulatory mapping, child participation.

CONTROL	REQUIREMENT	EVIDENCE TO PRODUCE	
CS-GO.1.1	SHALL designate a named Child Safety Officer.	D	CSO appointment record.
CS-GO.1.2	CSO SHALL report directly to executive leadership.	D	Org chart / reporting line.
CS-GO.2.1	All staff with child-data access SHALL complete annual child-safety training.	L	Training completion records.
CS-GO.2.2	Moderators SHALL receive trauma-informed training.	L	Specialised training records.
CS-GO.2.3	A moderator wellbeing programme SHALL be in place.	P	Wellbeing programme document.
CS-GO.3.1	Vendors processing child data SHALL be audited.	D	Vendor audit reports.
CS-GO.3.2	Vendor contracts SHALL include child-data protection clauses.	A	Contract clauses.
CS-GO.4.1	SHALL maintain documented regulatory compliance mapping.	D	Compliance mapping document.
CS-GO.4.2	Mapping SHALL be updated within 90 days of new requirements.	L	Mapping changelog.
CS-GO.5.1	SHALL comply with child-safety laws in every jurisdiction served.	D	Jurisdiction compliance register.
CS-GO.5.2	Consent thresholds SHALL be configurable per jurisdiction.	C	Per-jurisdiction configuration.
CS-GO.6.1	SHOULD include external advisory input in governance.	D	Advisory records.
CS-GO.6.2	Child-safety policies SHALL be reviewed at least annually.	L	Review log.
CS-GO.7.1	Children's voices SHALL be included in safety design and review.	D	Child-participation records.
CS-GO.7.2	Feedback mechanisms SHALL be accessible to child users.	D	Feedback channel walkthrough.
CS-GO.8.1	SHALL provide age-appropriate digital-literacy resources.	D	Published resources.

CONTROL	REQUIREMENT	EVIDENCE TO PRODUCE
CS-GO.8.2	SHOULD build children's resilience and digital skills.	D Feature / resource evidence.

FROM EVIDENCE TO CERTIFICATION

- **1 • Assemble the pack.** Gather the artefacts above for every applicable control. Most platforms already hold the majority through existing DSA/GDPR/AADC work.
- **2 • Pre-screen.** Custorian runs an automated first-look assessment of your live service to identify obvious gaps before formal review.
- **3 • Conformity assessment.** An independent accredited Certification Body reviews the evidence pack and tests the live service against the controls.
- **4 • Certified.** On conformity, the “Custorian Certified” mark is issued under licence, with annual surveillance and re-assessment.

Founding cohort. Pilot platforms are assessed first and help shape the certification scheme. Apply at custorian.org.